

By JACK HAND
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The National League took a day off Good Friday after three days of action that produced 341,809 paid admissions, a new manager in Philadelphia and six men hitting .500 or better.

If there was one development that stood out above all others in the first few days it was recognition that Chuck Dressen had taken a firm hold in Milwaukee.

The appearance of Lew Burdette in the bullpen and the quick hook for Warren Spahn on opening day was a solid hint. As soon so Chuck hit Philadelphia for a weekend series, he announced that Spahn, too, would be in the bullpen if needed against the Phils. Juan Pizarro was out there Thursday.

Mathews "Take Charge"

Noting that Red Schoendienst had enough to do to supervise his own comeback after losing a year because of tuberculosis, Dressen appointed Eddie Mathews the "take charge guy" on the infield.

When Philadelphia started a left-handed pitcher, Dressen revealed he planned to platoon center and left. He brought in Mel Roach to replace Al Spangler in left and sent Felix Mantille to center instead of Bill Bruton. Of course, the left field situation may be changed when Wes Covington is ready for full time duty.

Philadelphia had its largest opening crowd in two years, 32,038, to see acting Manager Andy Cohen make the right moves and beat Dressen. Frantic shifting of pitchers and pinch hitters finally brought up Joe Koppe. His single off Johnny Logan's glove won the game 5-4 in the 10th inning.

Although the hitting of Bobby Del Greco and the relief pitching of Don Cardwell were encouraging to Phil fans, the early bombing of Curt Simmons was a disappointment. Gene Mauch takes over as boss starting Saturday.

Pirates Top Swatters